

TOPIC 4: SEPARATION OF POWERS

1. Meaning

Separation of powers means dividing government authority among three arms: the **legislature** (makes laws), the **executive** (implements laws and runs government) and the **judiciary** (interprets laws and settles disputes). No single arm should hold all power.

2. Checks and Balances

Each arm can limit the others: e.g. the legislature can pass laws and oversee the executive; the executive can assent to or (within limits) withhold assent to bills; the judiciary can declare laws or actions unconstitutional. This prevents tyranny and encourages accountability.

3. Importance

Separation of powers protects liberty, supports the rule of law and makes government more transparent and answerable to the people.

4. Summary

Dividing power among legislature, executive and judiciary, with checks and balances, is a cornerstone of constitutional democracy.

End of Topic 4